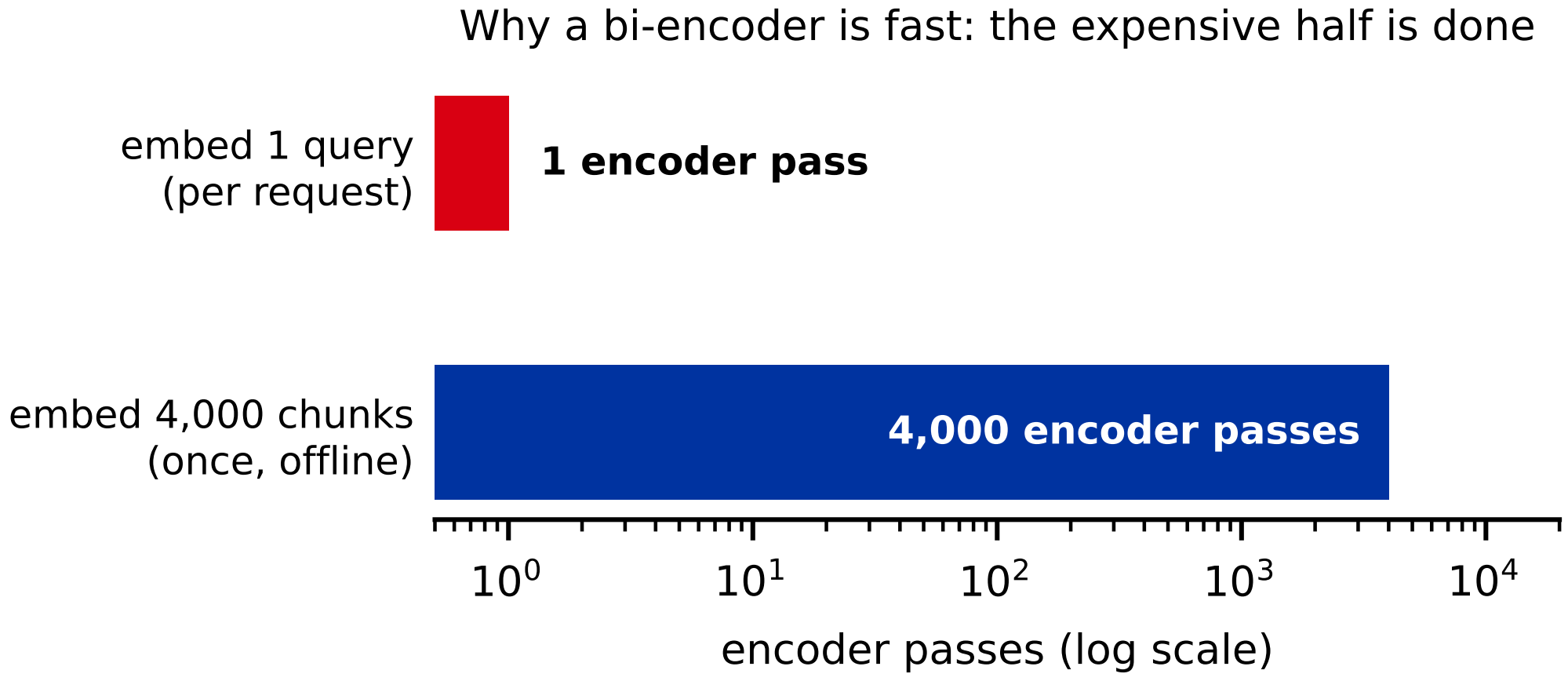
Why a bi-encoder is fast: the expensive half is done
embed 1 query
(per request)
1 encoder pass
embed 4,000 chunks
(once, offline)
4,000 encoder passes
10^0
10^1
10^2
10^3
10^4
encoder passes (log scale)